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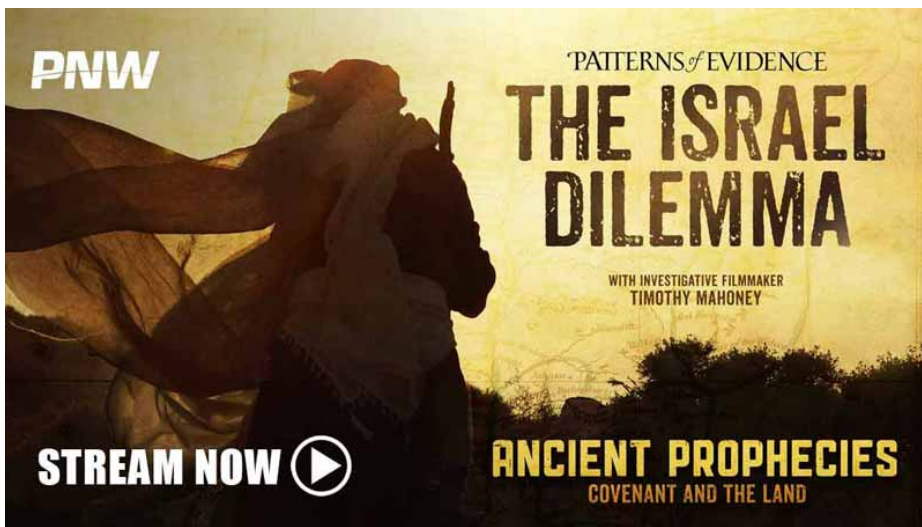
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ARTICLE

China Is Rehearsing For War-And America Is Already Part Of The Script





BY PNW STAFF JULY 08, 2026

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For years, many Americans have viewed rising tensions over Taiwan as a distant geopolitical dispute--something happening on the other side of the Pacific with little bearing on daily life. But recent military developments suggest that China is no longer merely preparing to defend its interests. It is openly rehearsing how to defeat America's military should a conflict erupt.

That should get our attention.

In just the past year, China has accelerated military activities that paint a troubling picture. It recently conducted a rare intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) launch into the Pacific from a nuclear-powered submarine--the first such publicly known submarine-based test in roughly four decades and only the second long-range Pacific demonstration in modern history.

Although the missile reportedly carried a dummy warhead, the message was unmistakable: China wants the world to know its nuclear deterrent is becoming increasingly mobile, survivable, and capable of reaching targets across the globe.

At nearly the same time, newly released satellite imagery revealed China constructing yet another replica of a U.S. Navy Arleigh Burke-class destroyer deep in the Taklamakan Desert. This wasn't built for tourism or propaganda. Analysts believe it is another target used to refine China's anti-ship missile capabilities.

In other words, Beijing isn't simply talking about defeating American warships--it is practicing.

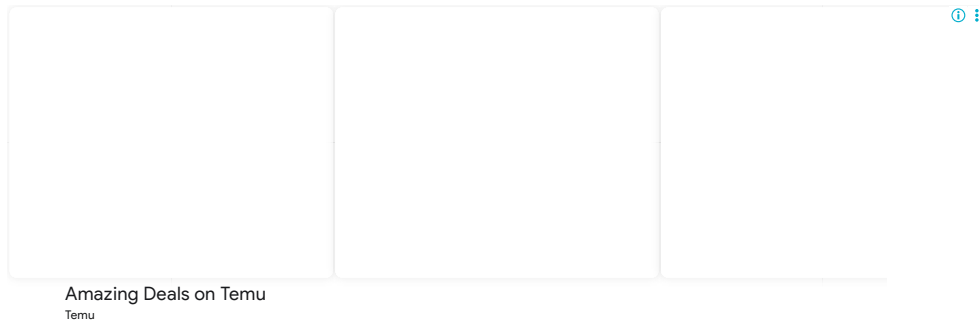
And it isn't stopping there.

Over recent years, China has also built mock versions of Taiwan's Presidential Office, government buildings, and city streets for military exercises. These facilities allow the People's Liberation Army (PLA) to rehearse urban assaults, command seizures, and precision strikes against Taiwan's political leadership.

Military planners often say armies fight the way they train.

China is training for Taiwan.





A Navy Built for More Than Defense

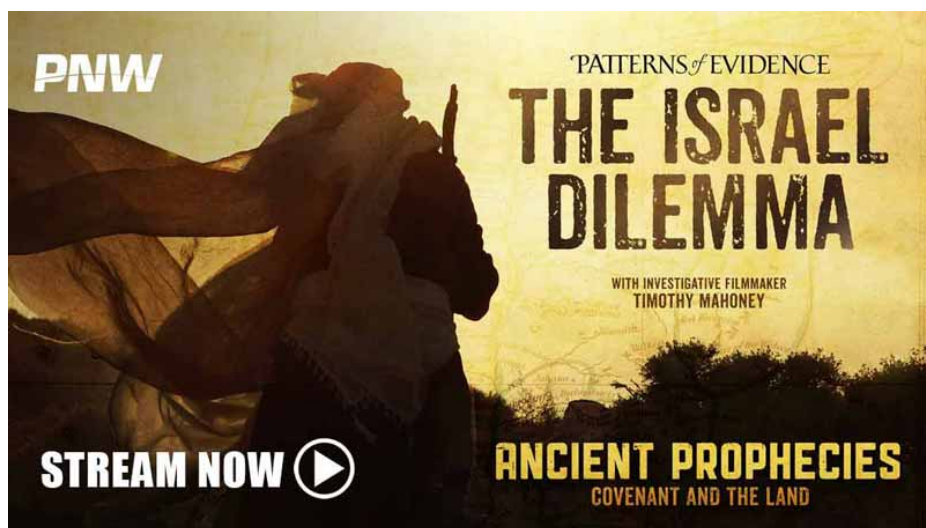
China now possesses the world's largest navy by number of warships, with well over 370 battle force ships and submarines--a number expected to continue growing. While the United States still enjoys advantages in global reach, carrier aviation, and combat experience, China's naval expansion has been breathtaking.

Over the past year alone, Beijing has continued commissioning advanced destroyers, frigates, amphibious assault ships, and nuclear-powered submarines while expanding its aircraft carrier program. The sea trials of its next-generation carrier, *Fujian*, represent another milestone. Unlike China's earlier carriers, *Fujian* employs electromagnetic catapults similar to those used by the U.S. Navy, allowing heavier aircraft and more efficient launch operations.

China has also dramatically expanded its coast guard and maritime militia--civilian-looking vessels that increasingly serve strategic military purposes by harassing Philippine, Vietnamese, and Taiwanese ships without technically triggering open warfare.

These are not isolated developments.

They form part of a comprehensive strategy.



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Why Now?

Timing matters.

China's economy has slowed considerably compared to the explosive growth that fueled its rise over the past two decades. Domestic challenges--from youth unemployment to real estate instability--have increased pressure on Beijing's leadership.

History shows governments facing internal difficulties sometimes emphasize external threats to rally national unity.



At the same time, President Xi Jinping has repeatedly declared that "reunification" with Taiwan cannot be postponed indefinitely. U.S. intelligence officials have stated that Xi has instructed the PLA to be capable of conducting an invasion of Taiwan by 2027--not that war is inevitable by then, but that the military should be ready if ordered.

Readiness requires rehearsal.

The missile tests.

The mock American warships.

The simulated Taiwanese government buildings.

The massive naval exercises surrounding Taiwan.

These pieces fit together.

Taiwan Isn't "Their Problem"

Many Americans understandably ask: Why should we care?

Because if Taiwan falls, the consequences won't stay in Asia.

Taiwan manufactures roughly 90% of the world's most advanced semiconductors. Those tiny chips power nearly everything--smartphones, automobiles, hospital equipment, artificial intelligence systems, financial networks, military hardware, and electrical infrastructure.

Disruption to Taiwan's semiconductor industry would ripple through the global economy almost immediately.

Beyond economics lies credibility.

The United States has spent decades building alliances throughout the Indo-Pacific. Japan, South Korea, Australia, and the Philippines all rely upon American security commitments. If China successfully seized Taiwan without meaningful resistance, allies across the region would inevitably question whether America's security guarantees still carry weight.

That uncertainty could trigger a regional arms race--or encourage other authoritarian powers to pursue territorial ambitions of their own.

The Testing Never Stops

China's military pressure rarely makes front-page news because much of it happens incrementally.

Nearly every week, Chinese aircraft cross Taiwan's air defense identification zone.

Chinese naval vessels circle the island.

Cyberattacks probe Taiwanese infrastructure.

Spy balloons, underwater cables, satellite surveillance, electronic warfare, and increasingly sophisticated artificial intelligence are becoming integral parts of Beijing's strategy.

Each operation gathers intelligence.

Each exercise identifies weaknesses.

Each test conditions the world to accept a slightly higher level of aggression than before.

This is sometimes called the "boiling frog" strategy--not one dramatic act, but a steady escalation that gradually normalizes behavior once considered extraordinary.



Christians Should Watch Carefully

Scripture does not tell believers to panic over headlines, but it does repeatedly instruct us to remain watchful and discerning. Jesus warned that nations would rise against nations and that increasing global instability would characterize the period leading to His return.

Whether today's events ultimately lead to a Taiwan conflict remains unknown. Wise leaders can still preserve peace through strength, diplomacy, and deterrence.

But pretending these military preparations are merely symbolic would be dangerously naïve.

China isn't simply building ships.

It is building options.

It isn't merely testing missiles.

It is testing resolve.

And every replica warship in the desert, every missile launched into the Pacific, every carrier launched to sea, and every simulated attack on Taiwan sends the same unmistakable message:

Beijing is preparing for a conflict it hopes never comes--but intends to be ready if it does.

The question is whether the free world is preparing with the same seriousness.

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